

Ankle Pain - Female (Child)

Algorithm 1464 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- UAT-only adult and pediatric non-traumatic ankle-pain pathway screening for joint infection, systemic illness, inability to bear weight and neurovascular compromise before in-person assessment.
- Child patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [LOCATION] Where exactly is the pain?
2. [DURATION] How long has the pain lasted?
3. [YES_NO] Is the skin around the ankle swollen and hot?
4. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the age; is there pregnancy/postpartum status, inability to bear weight, systemic illness, diabetes/immune risk, hidden injury, neurovascular change, or "in a child" refusal to use the limb or safeguarding concern?
5. [CAREGIVER_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Motor Vehicle Accident

Did this problem begin with a motor vehicle crash or as part of a multi-system crash injury?

A motor vehicle crash or multi-system crash injury belongs in the Motor Vehicle Accident pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is ankle pain severe with inability to bear weight, neurovascular change, or a hot swollen joint plus marked systemic illness, confusion, breathing change, collapse or rapid deterioration?

Severe functional loss, neurovascular compromise, or marked systemic deterioration requires emergency assessment through the Qatar pathway.

1. Disposition level 40

Does the child have ankle pain without the urgent infection features above?

NHS.UK joint pain guidance specifically advises clinical review when a child has joint problems.

Advice

Qatar emergency ankle-joint response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for a hot swollen joint with systemic illness, severe pain, inability to bear weight, deformity, a cold/pale/blue/numb foot, or rapid deterioration. Do not allow self-driving or force movement. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: increasing swelling or redness; fever or systemic illness; cannot bear weight.

Clinical review for childhood ankle pain

- Arrange primary-care review for the child's joint problem. Rest the ankle when needed and use a wrapped cold pack for up to 20 minutes while awaiting review.
- Call Back If: pain or swelling worsens; redness, fever or inability to bear weight.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for a hot swollen joint with systemic illness, severe pain, inability to bear weight, deformity, a cold/pale/blue/numb foot, or rapid deterioration. Do not allow self-driving or force movement. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Joint pain" (non-injury pain guidance), <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/joint-pain/> (page last reviewed 26 February 2026) - applied to non-traumatic ankle pain

Provenance

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